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Senate of Virginia Floor Session, Friday, February 27, 2026

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[00:31:00] sessions, catch up on past meetings, and explore our full archives anytime on the Senate of

[00:31:05] Virginia's YouTube channel. The Senate will come to order. The senators will please take their seats.

[00:31:47] those persons not entitled to the privileges of the floor will retire to the gallery. The senators and all in attendance will please stand if you are able. We will be led in prayer today by the Reverend Ralph Stephen Hodge from Second Baptist Church in Richmond and following the prayer everyone will please remain standing. We will be led in the Pledge of Allegiance to the flag of the United States of America by Senate page Neela Saravana Kumar of Prince William. Let us bow our heads in prayer. Most high and holy God we humble ourselves

[00:32:24] before you to give you glory and honor. We thank you ahead of time for all that you will do. We thank you for the beauty of creation. We thank you for the beauty of humanity and we thank you for the opportunity to honor you through service to our world and to the constituents of the great state of Virginia. Lord give Give us the strength and courage to serve with love, kindness, gentleness, and compassion.

[00:32:49] Lord, lead these public officials to serve with the desire to correct injustices and promote fairness. Guide this body to be bold and courageous, to fund more affordable housing, provide better access to health care, offer real solutions to gun violence, easier access to mental health treatment, and open the doors of educational opportunity for all.

[00:33:11] them to be the best stewards of the people's resources and give them and help them to resist serving for selfish gain and vain ambition. Lord give them ears that hear the voices that are often ignored and forgotten. Give them the voices to speak up for the voiceless and let them use their power to give strength to the weak. Let them govern in a way that fosters community and not division. Cause them to cast off any weight that easily entangles and straighten any crooked places that may be within. Help them govern in a way that respects the rights and freedoms of all. Let them govern in a way that protects and support

[00:33:45] those who have limited resources and empty them of all pride and arrogance. Remove all malice and strife. Cleanse them from iniquity and wickedness and fill them with humility, mercy, love, and wisdom. And Lord, most of all, let love reign. Let love guide. Let love be at the center of all of their governance. In your name we pray. Amen. I pledge allegiance to the flag of the United States of america and to the republic for which stands one nation under god indivisible with liberty and

[00:34:23] justice for all the clerk will call the roll all those present please vote aye clerk will close the

[00:35:08] roll you have a quorum madam president senate journal for thursday february 26 2026 the senator from rockingham moves that the reading of the journal be waived all in favor of waiving the reading of the journal will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all

the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll ayes 32 nose 7. ayes 32 nose 7 the reading of the journal is waived the clerk will report

[00:35:46] any communications from the house of delegates senior the senator from eastern fairfax morning Good morning, Madam President. Good morning. Madam President, I move to waive the reading of the communication from the House of Delegates. The question is, shall the reading of the communication be waived?

[00:36:03] All in favor of waiving the reading of the communication from the House of Delegates will record their votes, aye. Those opposed, no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote?

[00:36:19] The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 29, noes 10. The reading of the journal is not waived. reading of the house communication is not waived and president senator from Franklin County thank you madam president having voted on the pervading prevailing side where we voted not to waive the communications from the house I now because it's Friday ask that this vote be reconsidered thank you senator

[00:36:56] let's get the vote right this time the question is I think I just got set up shall the vote by which the reading of the house communication was not waived be reconsidered. All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed no. Are the Senators ready to vote? Have all the Senators voted? Do any

[00:37:24] Senators desire to change their vote? This is reconsider. The Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 39, no zero. Ayes 39, no zero. The motion is agreed to. Senator from Eastern Fairfax. Madam President, I move to waive the reading of the communication of the House of Delegates again. The question is, shall the reading of the communication be waived. All in favor of waiving the reading of the communication from the House of Delegates will record their votes aye. Those opposed no. Are the

[00:38:02] senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 34, noes 5. Ayes 34, noes 5. The reading of the communication is waived. The clerk will report any communications from the governor. We do not have any Madam President. We've now arrived in the time of our morning hour when we have the honor of welcoming our distinguished guests who are joining us today in the Senate gallery. I remind us of our normal procedure. A senator will rise and provide an introduction for

[00:38:42] their visitors. I will then offer the welcome of the Senate. I ask that we all hold our applause until I've had the opportunity to provide the Senate's welcome. The chair recognizes the senator from Western Henrico. - Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I rise for an introduction.

[00:38:58] - Senator has the floor. - Thank you, Madam President, members of the body. Today's invocation was given to us by Pastor Ralph Hodge, who was, and if you could please stand, yeah, who was born in DC and spent his formative years in Maryland. However, he became born again during the summer of 1979 and accepted his call to the ministry in 1989 while attending Howard University.

[00:39:19] It was during his time there that he really began to live a spirit-filled life. He was actus in the Campus Crusade for Christ on Howard's campus and served the Fort Washington Baptist Church as an ordained deacon before becoming an ordained minister. He graduated from Howard University with a bachelor's science degree in chemistry and applied science in 1992, and then received his master's in divinity from Virginia Union in 1995.

[00:39:41] During the winter of 2002, he answered the call to become the pastor of the Second Baptist Church of South Richmond, Senator Jones's area, and his installation celebration was held on April 26, 2003. He's married to Cassandra and together they are raising four sons, Tyrone, Samuel, Isaiah, and Stephen.

[00:39:57] And I would hope we'd give him a warm Senate welcome. - Thank you, Senator, for that introduction. And please remain standing, Reverend. We are so delighted to have you join us in the Senate chamber this morning. Thank you for your beautiful prayer and the blessings that you offered to the chamber and its members.

[00:40:14] Senators, I ask that we give the warm welcome of the Senate to Reverend Ralph Stephen Hodge from Richmond. - The chair recognizes the senior senator from Loudoun.

[00:40:30] - Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I ask that the journal reflect that my teammate is away on personal pressing business. - This journal will so reflect. Thank you, Senator. The chair recognizes the senator from Eastern Fairfax. - Madam President, I rise for announcement.

[00:40:45] - Senator has the floor. - There are two announcements, actually. Madam President, first of all, today was the day we were hoping to have all the delegation judicial selections in. I'm not sure if everybody's got them to be in or not. I know there's at least one jurisdiction that hasn't agreed yet.

[00:41:03] I'm not sure if there's others. I asked for a report from staff on that, but please get them in to Shannon Hurd at DLSASAP. We're going to be doing the interviews with judges, I think, on the week from today, I think, on March the 6th in the afternoon.

[00:41:19] By the way, if you're on the Courts of Justice Committee, note your calendar for that. And if there are any judges from your locality that you need to introduce, that'll be the day. And second introduction, Madam President. Announcement. Sorry, announcement. Second announcement is there will be a meeting of the Courts of Justice Committee upon adjournment to quickly re-refer a bill to finance so we can hit the revenue bill deadline. I want to make sure everybody on Courts knows that, so it'll only take a minute, so please stick around after adjournment.

[00:41:48] The chair recognizes the senator from Norfolk. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I rise for the purpose of an introduction. Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, in the gallery, we have one of our Paige alumni's and her family Abigail Wentz and I would ask her to stand and that we give her the warm welcome of the senate thank you senator for that introduction and if our former Paige Abigail Wentz and her family will please stand we are so delighted to

[00:42:22] have you visit us again Abigail and we know that the remarkable work of the senate page program we We have wonderful pages in this cohort as we do every year. And we are just happy to welcome you back to the Senate.

[00:42:39] Welcome your family as well. And I see a future page standing right beside you. Senators, I ask that we give the very warm welcome of the Senate to former page Abigail Wentz and her family.

[00:42:56] The chair recognizes the junior senator from Loudoun. Good afternoon, Madam President. Good afternoon. I rise for the purpose of an introduction. Senator has the floor. thank you madam president i along with the senior senator from loudon would like to introduce a non-profit advocacy group today in the gallery we are joined by va our way a non-profit advocacy organization based in loudon

county founded in 2017 by concerned virginians seeking greater transparency in state government va our way's mission is to champion good governance in virginia

[00:43:31] by promoting nonpartisan open and informed discourse between citizens and legislators, increasing public engagement, and advancing practical transparency. They advocate for critical issues that affect all Virginians, including expanding access to affordable housing, strengthening vocational and career technical educational opportunities, and ensuring access to quality and affordable health care.

[00:43:55] Here in the gallery, representing VA Our Way are its founders, Margaret Gupta, Karen Schofield, and Nancy Rice. I hope you will all join me in extending them a warm welcome of the Senate. Thank you, Senator, for that introduction, and welcome to VA Our Way. Thank you to all the work that this group is doing, and especially the leadership that's being provided by Karen Schofield, Nancy Rice and Margaret Gupta, we really appreciate all that you do especially the focus around critical issues in housing and health care and

[00:44:34] education. Thank you so much for the advocacy in these very very special areas. Senators, I ask that we give the warm welcome of the Senate to the representatives of VA Our Way and that is Karen and Nancy and Margaret. The chair recognizes a senior senator from Prince William.

[00:45:04] Thank you madam president I rise for the purpose of two introductions. Senator has the floor. Thank you madam president as you'll see we have two high schools today here from Stafford and madam president first I'm proud to introduce students and educators from the leadership education and public service center or better known as LEAPS at Mountain View High located in stafford county and i ask that they please rise and be recognized and madam president the leaps center empowers students to step beyond the class and into real civic engagement and madam president these students aren't just learning about leadership and public service

[00:45:40] they're actively living in it and today they're not observers they're advocates they're using critical thinking collaboration and problem solving to develop and engage directly in the legislative process by attending committees and showing up in the space they're demonstrating what it means to be informed, involved, and invested in their community. And the presence in this chamber is powerful and signals that the next generation is not just waiting for the future, they are prepared to be a part of it, to shape it, and make it a part of our communities. And so please join me and welcome them to the Senate. Thank you, Senator, for that introduction. And quite a cohort is

[00:46:17] joining us this afternoon in the gallery. Thank you so much to all of our students who are part of the LEAPS program, thank you for what you are doing to not only to learn about the issues that impact your communities and also how state government works, but also all the skills and the insights and the passion that you bring on these issues. We're delighted to have you join us in the Senate gallery. Senators, I ask that we give a very warm welcome of the Senate to the participants of the LEAPS Center program from Mountain View High School.

[00:46:52] Senator has the floor. Thank you Madam President and for my second introduction and also on behalf of the center from Stafford, Senator Durant, I'm happy to also introduce in the gallery today we have members of the Black Student Union from Brook Point High School in Stafford, Virginia and I ask that they please rise and be recognized. And Madam President, these students are here today during Black History Month to advocate for the rights of students to promote social justice policies that uplift the

Stafford community. These students are no stranger to this chamber, Madam President. They have been here

[00:47:28] before and are back today to promote representation and visibility. Madam President, these young people sat in committees and met with legislators from both chambers and to advocate for change because we know history has shown that courage can be contagious and hope can take a life of its own. I ask that the Senate join me in welcoming these bright young scholars, Madam President. Thank you Senator for that introduction and welcome to the representatives of the Black Student Union from Mount from Brook Point High School. We're so delighted by all of the work that you do, the advocacy on so many issues. Hope you've had a wonderful opportunity to meet with several of your legislators and have

[00:48:06] these important conversations. Senators, I ask that we give the very warm welcome of the Senate to the student representatives from the BSU organization at Brook Point High School. The senator from Lynchburg.

[00:48:31] Thank you, Madam President. I rise for the purposes of an introduction. The Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. Joining us today in the gallery, we have students from the Liberty University Helms School of Government, led by their very distinguished professor, Aaron Van Allen. I would ask if y'all could stand, please.

[00:48:54] Members of the Senate, these students are here visiting their elected officials today and are here to see firsthand the legislative process. Now I'm going to tell you, Madam President, we almost had a near tragedy.

[00:49:10] They had been directed down to the House Gallery. Fortunately, they have been redirected to the Senate Gallery where they can see the legislative process unfold by sophisticated and civilized legislators. So they are clearly bright and energetic and they are our state and our country's next generation of leaders.

[00:49:33] It's a pleasure to have y'all here watching what we do in Mr. Jefferson's Capitol. I would ask that we please give them the warm welcome of the Senate. As a reminder, please let me provide a welcome from the Senate, and then we will applaud.

[00:49:56] But tragedy averted. Thank you, Senator from Lynchburg, for pointing out the right direction to the right chamber. We're so glad that you are here this morning. Thank you to our representatives and the professor and faculty who are joining us from Liberty University.

[00:50:13] I hope you've had a tremendous opportunity to meet with your state representatives, to talk to a variety of different offices, and to convey the concerns and the issues that you are focused on. So thank you so much for being here with us today.

[00:50:29] Senators, I ask that we give the very warm welcome of the Senate to the representatives from liberty university is there any other business for the morning hour the clerk will call the calendar the senate calendar for friday february 27 2026 page three unfinished business

[00:51:02] house house bill six the house has rejected the senate substitute the chair recognizes the senator from arlington thank you thank you madam president i move that the senate insist on its substitute and request the committee of conference the president senator from eastern fairfax thank you

madam president um we're gonna do this a little differently today because a whole bunch of these save us some time and so madam president i move that all the house bills on the

[00:51:38] unfinished business on pages three through five house bill six through house bill 1278 be placed into a block to insist and request committees of conference any senator desiring a bill to be removed from the block please do so after the clerk has read the number of the bill the question is shall the house bills on the unfinished business on pages 3 through 5 house bill 6 through house bill 1278 be placed in the block to insist and a request committees of conference with the understanding that any senator desiring a bill be removed from the block will do so after the clerk has

[00:52:14] read the number of the bill all in favor of that motion will say aye those opposed no the eyes have it the motion is agreed to the bills are before us in the block, the clerk will read the number of the bills. House Bill 6, House Bill 125, House Bill 276, House Bill 396, House Bill 584, House Bill 705, House Bill 1278.

[00:52:49] The question is, shall the Senate insist and request committees of conference on the House bills in the block? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 39, noes 0. Ayes 39, noes 0. The Senate has insisted and requested

[00:53:23] committees of conference. Page 6, Unfinished Business Senate. Senate Bill 680. The House has passed, it has passed the House with a substitute. The senator from Botetat. Thank you, Madam President. I move that we concur with the House substitute and speaking to that motion. Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. The the substitute does three things. It changes the the date for the the change to the amount of money that can be held by different agencies,

[00:54:02] regulatory agencies, from their fees. Moves that up to July of 2028 as opposed 30 2032 it also if there's gonna be any any fee changes to the licensure fees that they report this to the Secretary of Finance and finally if those fees are imposed then they would make a report to the money committees of both the House and the Senate by November 1st of every year that's all it does so hope that we will support the amendment the question is shall the Senate concur with the house substitute all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those

[00:54:41] opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll eyes 39 no zero the Senate concurs the house with substitute the senator from Eastern Henrico thank you madam president I move that we concur with a house substitute and speaking to that motion senator has the floor thank you madam

[00:55:16] Madam President, this substitute changes the eligibility and family contribution details, but ultimately it does not do harm from what we originally sent out of this body, so I'm fine with them and ask that we concur. The question is, shall the Senate concur with the substitute from the House on Senate Bill 3?

[00:55:38] All in favor of the motion will record their votes, aye. Those opposed, no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll i's 39 no zero eyes 39 no zero the senate concurs senate bill 26 has passed the house with amendments the senator from

[00:56:13] western prince william eastern eastern prince william thank you madam president madam president i move that the senate concur with the house amendment and speaking to that motion senator The floor amendment made by Delegate Sewell is a technical change from the Department of Environmental Quality, DQ asked for this change to narrow the stormwater exemptions to ensure they specifically apply to solar canopies over parking lots and do not inadvertently apply to solar canopies over other areas like landscaping.

[00:56:45] The attention is that the same amendment be made to the delegates bill. When that bill is heard in local government, I ask that we pass. The question is, shall the Senate concur with the House amendment for Senate Bill 26?

[00:57:02] All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 20, noes 19.

[00:57:18] Ayes 20, noes 19. The Senate concurs. Senate Bill 44 has passed the House with amendment. Senator from Eastern Fairfax. Thank you, Madam President.

[00:57:35] With the recommendation to be rejected, I move that we concur with the House Amendment and speak to that motion. Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. This is Senator from Western Prince William's Cemetery bill. I'm not sure what the difference is, but I know she doesn't agree with it.

[00:57:51] So if anybody would like an explanation, I guess we can take it by it for the day. But I think a no vote's a pretty safe vote, so I'd just ask that we reject it. With the recommendation that it be rejected, the question is, shall the Senate concur with the House Amendment for Senate Bill 44?

[00:58:10] All in favor of that motion will please record their votes aye. Those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll.

[00:58:27] Ayes 0, noes 39. Ayes 0, noes 39. The Senate does not concur. Senate Bill 58 has passed the house with amendment. The Senator from Arlington.

[00:58:42] Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I move that we concur with the amendment from the house and speaking to that motion. Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. What the house did is it extended the effective date of this measure until January 1, 2027.

[00:58:59] And this was to ease the administration of the delayed enactment, if you will, or the extended receipt date for the mail-in ballot.

[00:59:14] Mail-in ballot would be received on 5 p.m. the third day after the election. That's the underlying bill. And the extended date was requested by the Board of Elections. So with that explanation, I hope we concur.

[00:59:33] The question is, shall the Senate concur with the House Amendment for Senate Bill 58? All in favor of that motion will record their vote, aye. Those opposed, no. Are the Senators ready to vote? Have all the Senators voted? Do any Senators desire to change their vote?

[00:59:54] The Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 21, noes 18. Ayes 21, noes 18. The Senate concurs. bill 60 has passed the house with a substitute the senator from Hampton thank you madam president I move that we

concur with the house substitute and speaking to that motion the Senate senator has the floor thank you madam president the house substitute expands the number of parole members and on line 106 it removes the words or not to address the fiscal impact and it removes

[01:00:28] section 53.1-155 to address that fiscal impact and with that explanation madam President, I move that we concur with the House substitute. The question is, shall the Senate concur with the House substitute for Senate Bill 60? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye.

[01:00:45] Those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted. Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 20, noes 19. Ayes 20, noes 19.

[01:01:00] The Senate concurs. Senate Bill 94 has passed the House with a substitute. The senior senator from Prince William. Thank you, Madam President. With the recommendation that be rejected, I move that the substitute be agreed to.

[01:01:16] Speaking to the motion. Senator has the floor. Thank you. This needs to be worked out. Additional information in conference and the senator from Western Prince William has requested to do so. So I appreciate the, again, recommendation that it be rejected. With the recommendation that it be rejected, the question is, shall the Senate concur with the House substitute for Senate Bill 94?

[01:01:36] in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll zero nose 39 i zero nose 39 the senate does not concur senate bill 134 has passed the

[01:02:04] house with the substitute the senator from hampton senator has the floor madam president the house made some substantive changes with regard to re-benchmarking and added some requirements and changed the annual reporting date and given that i think we need to take this to conference and again i move that we reject the house substitute with the recommendation that we concur with the recommendation that it be rejected the question is shall the senate concur with the house substitute

[01:02:42] for senate bill 134 all in favor of the motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll i zero knows 39 i zero knows 39 the senate does not concur senate bill 140 has passed the house with a substitute the senior senator from prince Thank you, Madam President.

[01:03:15] With the recommendation it be rejected, I move the House Substitute be agreed to and speaking to the motion. Senator has the floor. There's just a slight difference between the House Bill 325. We're going to reject this and accept the, get the Senate version in its posture.

[01:03:31] So we ask that this be rejected. With the recommendation that it be rejected, the question is, shall the Senate concur with the House Substitute for Senate Bill 140? in favor of the motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll zero no's 39 i zero no's 39 the senate does not concur

[01:04:06] senate bill 160 has passed the house with a substitute the senior senator from loudon madam president i move we concur with the house substitute in speaking to that motion senator has the floor the house per usual has included some additional commas into this bill I think two in this particular case and they don't seem to change the bill so I would move we concur the question is shall the Senate concur with

the house substitute for Senate bill 160 all in favor of the motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the

[01:04:43] senators voted. Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 21, noes 18. Ayes 21, noes 18. The Senate concurs. Senate Bill 162 has passed the House with a substitute. The Senator from Hampton. Thank you, Madam President. I move that we concur with the House substitute and speak into that motion. Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President.

[01:05:16] the house substitute adds an enactment clause that clarifies that the legislation will only go into effect if the constitutional amendment passes and with that explanation madam president i renew the motion to concur the question is shall the senate concur with the house substitute for senate bill 162 all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote. Have all the senators voted. Do any senators desire to change their vote?

[01:05:47] The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 18, noes 20. Ayes 18, noes 20. The Senate does not concur.

[01:06:04] Senator from Eastern Fairfax. Hey, Madam President, I haven't voted on the prevailing side by which the bill was rejected. I'd move that we reconsider that vote so I can pay attention this time the question is shall the vote by which house senate bill 162 was was not passed be reconsidered all in favor of the motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote

[01:06:38] the clerk will close the roll ayes 39 no zero ayes 39 no zero the motion is agreed to senator from Hampton. Once again, Madam President, I move that we concur with the House substitute. The question is, shall the Senate concur with the House substitute for Senate Bill 162? All in favor of that motion will record their

[01:07:14] votes aye. Those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 20, noes 19. Ayes 20, noes 19. The Senate concurs. Senate Bill 167 has passed the House with a substitute. Senator from Western Henrico. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I'm going to move that we concur with the House substitute speaking of that motion. Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, members of the body, this is a bill

[01:07:51] that passed out here 40 to 0 about consolidating financial aid programs. The House just had an extra enactment clause that has Chev do a work group to figure out how we can have a better financial aid system this is something all the colleges want to do I think it's something we all want to do and so I would ask us to accept concur the house substitute the question is shall the Senate concur with the house substitute for Senate bill 167 all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the

[01:08:26] senators voted. Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 39, no 0. Ayes 39, no 0. The Senate concurs. Senate bill 226 has passed the house with a substitute. Senator from Eastern Fairfax. Thank you, Madam President. I would, with the recommendation be rejected, I move we concur with the house substitute and speak of that motion. Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. Ladies and gentlemen, this is the bill that I was caring about composting. I went over to the house I think it was CC&T committee

[01:09:04] maybe and they slapped a sub on it that I had no idea what was in it. But anyway there's some slight differences between myself and and what they put on their their bill is more prescriptive than ours and I would just ask let's go to conference so we can figure out if there's a solution. With the recommendation that it be rejected with the recommendation that it be rejected the question is shall the Senate concur with the house substitute for Senate

[01:09:40] bill 226 all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll 0 knows 39 I 0 knows 39 the senate does not concur senate bill 286 has passed the house with a substitute with amendments the senator from eastern henrico thank you madam president i move that we concur

[01:10:20] with sorry i move that we concur with the house substitute and excuse me the and amendments and speaking to that motion senator has the floor um madam president this simply adds vedp as a con a consultant partner along with Chev to ensure that we're aligning uh the internships that this legislation is targeting uh with workforce and economic development strategies and there's some minor language clarifying the scope of the coordinator but again i move that we concur with the house's substituted amendments the question is shall the senate concur with the

[01:10:54] house substitute with amendment for senate bill 286. all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Of all the senators voted, do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close

[01:11:25] the roll. Ayes 38, noes 0. Ayes 38, noes 0. The Senate concurs. Senate Bill 324, pass the House with a substitute. The senior senator from Prince William. Thank you, Madam President. With the recommendation that it be rejected, I move the House substitute and speak into the motion. Senator has the floor. President we still have a number of different differences between the House and Senate and need to send this to Congress to hammer the rest of it out. I appreciate the rejection. With the recommendation that it be rejected the question is

[01:12:04] shall the Senate concur with the House substitute for Senate Bill 324. All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed no. Are the Senators ready to vote have all the Senators voted do any Senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll I zero nose 38 the Senate does

[01:12:33] not concur Senate bill 329 the house with the substitute the senior senator from Loudoun madam president I move we concur with house substitute and speaking to that motion senator has the floor the differences in the bill are that this bill had a fee to help fund some sexual violence services the house had a higher fee we had a lower fee and we met in the middle on that the matter president that a move that we concur the question is shall the Senate concur with the house substitute for Senate bill 329 all in favor of that motion will

[01:13:11] record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll. Madam President. Senator from Virginia Beach. The vote count I believe was

[01:13:48] ayes 38, noes 1. The Senate does concur. Senate Bill 388 has passed the House with amendments. Senior Senator from Prince William. Thank you Madam President. With the recommendation that it be rejected, I move we concur with the House amendments and speak into the

motion. The Senator has the floor. Thank you Madam President. This is Faith in Housing Bills. We have a few other amendments that we need to make in conference. And so by rejecting this, this will allow us that time to do that. And I appreciate the body's consideration. With the recommendation that it be

[01:14:27] rejected, the question is, shall the Senate concur with the House amendments? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll.

[01:14:48] I zero, noes 38. I zero, noes 38. The Senate does not concur. Senate Bill 632 has passed the House with amendment. The Senator from Eastern Henrico.

[01:15:06] Thank you, Madam President. I move that we concur with the House amendment and speaking to that motion. The Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. There was a concern that this legislation could affect the 2026 election cycle. so the house has added that the bill would go into effect january 1 2027 to avoid those conflicts so i ask that we concur and move the bill forward the question is shall the senate concur with the house amendment to senate bill 632 all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to

[01:15:44] change their vote. The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 21, no 17. Ayes 21, no 17. The Senate concurs. Senate bill 648 has passed the house with the substitute. The senior senator from Loudoun. Thank you Madam President. Madam President with the recommendation that we reject the house substitute I move we concur to the house with the house substitute and speaking to that motion. Senator has the floor. The house has a slightly different way of looking at getting at the same problem that this bill seeks to address and say we just need to I think reject their substitute and send it over to conference and see if we can come up with some sort of an agreement

[01:16:24] thank you madam president with the recommendation that it be rejected the question is shall the senate concur with the house substitute all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote. The clerk will close the roll.

[01:16:49] I 0, noes 38. I 0, noes 38. The Senate does not concur. Senate Bill 669 has passed the House with a substitute. The junior senator from Virginia Beach. Thank you, Madam President. I move that the Senate concur with the House substitute.

[01:17:07] I'm speaking to that motion. Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. This is the bill that passed unanimously out of both chambers, but however, the House did catch a technical amendment, And so the technical amendment is to include an exclusion for the Child Health Insurance Program, also known as CHIP, which is administered by DMAS.

[01:17:25] This substitute will also catch, they also call it the, number one, to keep the bill consistent with the Virginia Code and just to clarify the necessary exemptions. And so it had to be a substitute because obviously it's all throughout the bill, the technical amendment is.

[01:17:43] So with that, a move we concur. The question is, shall the Senate concur with the House substitute for Senate Bill 669? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye, those opposed no, are the Senators ready to vote? Have all the Senators voted?

[01:18:00] Do any Senators desire to change their vote? The Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 38, noes 0. Ayes 38, noes 0. The Senate concurs.

[01:18:32] On page 22, uncontested calendar, House bills on third reading. senator from Eastern Fairfax. Madam President, I move that all the house bills on third reading on the uncontested calendar on pages 22 through 35, House Bill 190 to 1381, be advanced to their final passage in the block after the adoption of amendments thereto. Any senator desiring a move bill from the block, please do so after the clerk has read the number of the bill. The question is, shall house bills on the uncontested calendar, third reading, pages 22 through 35, House Bill 190 through House Bill 1381 be placed upon their final passage in a block after the adoption of any amendments thereto with the understanding that any senator

[01:19:12] desiring a bill be removed from the block will do so after the clerk has read the number of the bill. All in favor of that motion will say aye. Those opposed no. The ayes have it. The motion is agreed to. The bills are before us in the block. The clerk will read the number of the bills.

[01:19:30] substitute has been adopted by the Senate as bill 54 reported from the committee on finance and appropriations with amendments the senator from Portsmouth thank you madam president madam president I move that the committee amendments be agreed the question is shall the amendments from the committee on finance and appropriations be agreed to all in favor of that motion will say aye those opposed no the ayes have it the amendments are agreed to has bill 59

[01:20:09] Reported from the Committee on Privileges and Elections with the substitute. The junior senator from Virginia Beach. Thank you, Madam President. I move the substitute be agreed to. The question is, shall the substitute from the Committee on Privileges and Elections be agreed to? All in favor of the motion will say aye.

[01:20:26] Those opposed, no. The ayes have it. The substitute is agreed to. House Bill 88, reported from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations. House Bill 109, reported from the Committee on Agriculture, Conservation, and Natural Resources.

[01:20:43] House Bill 118, reported from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations with a substitute. Senator from Portsmouth. Thank you, Madam President. I move that the Committee of the Substitute be agreed to.

[01:21:00] The question is, shall the substitute from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations be agreed to? All in favor of the motion will say aye. Those opposed, no. The ayes have it. The substitute is agreed to.

[01:21:11] House Bill 124 reported from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations. House Bill 163 reported from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations. House Bill 195 reported from the Committee on Education and Health and from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations. House Bill 250 reported from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations with a substitute.

[01:21:41] the senator from Portsmouth the committee said to be agreed to the question is shall the substitute from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations be agreed to all in favor of the motion will say aye those opposed no the ayes have it the substitute is agreed to House Bill 317 reported from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations House Bill 325 reported from the Committee on General Laws and Technology with the substitute and from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations.

[01:22:18] The Senior Senator from Prince William. Thank you, Madam President. Move that the substitute be agreed to. The question is, shall the substitute from the Committee on General Laws and Technology be agreed to? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Those opposed, no. The ayes have it.

[01:22:34] The substitute is agreed to. House Bill 390, reported from the Committee on Agriculture, Conservation and Natural Resources with the substitute. senior senator from Fairfax thank you madam president I move that the committee substitute be agreed to the question is shall the substitute from the committee on agriculture conservation and natural resources be agreed to all in favor of the motion we'll say aye those opposed no the ayes have it the substitute is agreed to has bill 474 reported from the committee on finance and appropriations has bill 512 reported from the committee on

[01:23:13] agriculture conservation and natural resources has bill 543 reported from the committee on agriculture conservation and natural resources has bill 559 reported from the committee on transportation with a substitute and from the committee on finance and appropriations the senior senator from henrico thank you matter president matter president i move the committee substitute the question is shall the substitute from the committee on transportation be agreed to all in favor of the motion will say aye. Those opposed, no. The ayes have it. The

[01:23:49] substitute is agreed to. House Bill 662 reported from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations. House Bill 710 reported from the Committee on Agriculture Conservation and Natural Resources. House Bill 714 reported from the Committee on Agriculture Conservation and Natural Resources with a substitute. The senior senator from Fairfax. Thank you, Madam President. I move that the committee substitute be agreed to the question is shall the substitute from the committee on agriculture conservation and natural resources be agreed to all in favor of the motion will say aye those opposed

[01:24:27] no the eyes have it the substitute is agreed to post bill 747 reported from the committee on agriculture conservation and natural resources has bill 759 reported from the committee on agriculture conservation and natural resources has bill 817 reported from the committee on education and it reported from the committee on education and health with the substitute and from the committee on finance and appropriations the senator from Arlington thank you madam president I move that the substitute be agreed to the question is

[01:25:07] shall the substitute from the committee on education and health be agreed to all in favor of the motion will say aye those opposed no the eyes have it the substitute is agreed to. House Bill 845, reported from the Committee on Privileges and Elections with the substitute. The junior senator from Virginia Beach. Thank you, Madam President. I move the committee substitute be agreed to. The question is, shall the substitute from the Committee on Privileges and Elections be agreed to? All in favor of the motion will say aye. Those opposed, no. The ayes have it. The substitute is agreed to. House Bill 846, reported from the Committee on

[01:25:46] Agriculture Conservation and Natural Resources. House Bill 1081 reported from the Committee on Agriculture Conservation and Natural Resources. House Bill 1208 reported from the Committee on Education and Health with a substitute and from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations. The Senator from Arlington. Thank You Madam President I move that the substitute be agreed to. The question is shall the substitute from the Committee on Education and Health be agreed to? All in favor of the motion will say aye.

[01:26:20] Those opposed, no. The ayes have it. The substitute is agreed to. House Bill 1227, reported from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations. House Bill 1321, reported from the Committee on Privileges and Elections.

[01:26:37] House Bill 1358, reported from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations. House Bill 1381, reported from the Committee on Agriculture, Conservation and Natural Resources. The question is, shall the House bills in the block pass?

[01:26:55] All in favor of that motion will record their votes, aye. Those opposed, Senator from Roanoke. Can, one second, can House Bill 835 come out of the block and buy for the day?

[01:27:15] Page number? Page 33. On page 33. Without objection, House Bill 835 is out of the block and buy for the day. The question is, shall the House bills in the block pass, that is, all bills except for House Bill 835 on page 33?

[01:27:42] All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote?

[01:28:04] The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 37, no, zero. Ayes 37, no, zero. The bills in the block pass. Senator from Eastern Fairfax.

[01:28:36] Regular calendar, House bills on third reading. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, it being a Friday and being down three people at this point, I think at this point I'm going to ask that all the bills on the regular calendar, the House bills on the regular calendar, third reading, all go by for the day so we can focus on them when everybody's here and it's not a Friday.

[01:29:09] Without objection, all House bills on their third reading in the regular calendar will go by for the day. Page 50, uncontested calendar, House bills on second reading.

[01:29:28] The Senator from Eastern Fairfax. Madam President, I move with all the House bills on the second reading on the uncontested regular calendars, pages 50 through 76, House Bill 75 to 1441, that the rules be suspended and the second constitutional reading of the titles be dispensed with. The question is, shall the rules be suspended in the second reading of the titles of the House bills on the uncontested and regular calendars, pages 50 through 76, HB 75 through HB 1441, be dispensed with?

[01:29:59] All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye, those opposed no, are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted, do any senators desire to change their votes? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 37, noes 0.

[01:30:16] Ayes 37, noes 0, the reading of the titles is dispensed with. Senator from Eastern Fairfax. Thank you, Madam President. I ask all those bills go by for the day. The question is, shall the House bills on the uncontested and regular calendars, now on their third reading, be passed by for the day?

[01:30:36] All in favor of that motion, we'll say aye. Aye. Those opposed, no. The ayes have it. The bills will go by for the day. Senator from Eastern Fairfax. Inquiry of the Clerk, does that complete our Friday calendar?

[01:30:52] Yes, sir. We will return briefly to our morning hour. The chair recognizes the senator from Portsmouth. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, we have... I'm sorry, Madam President, I rise for the purposes of an introduction.

[01:31:10] Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, seated in the gallery today is a blast from the past. There's a person who was a member of the Page class of 1985, Mark Devers, and he's joined with by Eva Teague, who has served in several administrations, and so I'd like for you to extend to Mark Page from 1985 and his godmother, Eva Teague.

[01:31:41] Please extend to them a very warm welcome to the Senate. Thank you, Senator, for the introduction, and what a blast from the past. please remain standing our esteemed representative from the page class of 1985. Mr. Deaver we're delighted to have you join us looks like you're joined also by your family we're delighted to see everybody and thank you to your godmother Miss Eva Teague Hardy for joining us as well we hope you're having a wonderful visit at the capitol and getting an opportunity to chat with

[01:32:14] many of the representatives who might have been here when you were serving as a senate page senators i ask that we give the warm welcome of the senate to mark deaver from the page class of 1985 his family and his godmother the senator from eastern fairfax um thank you president rise for an announcement i guess senator has the floor thank you president i want to remind everybody on the courts committee we're going to have a meeting at my desk really quick after we adjourn um number

[01:32:51] number one. Number two, I want to make sure everybody noted we took by 14 pages of regular calendar. Today, there's probably another 10 or 12 or 14 second read regulars that are going to be added to that for Monday. Couple that with 65 bills and courts of justice still sitting there to be done before the end of the week. And then a very short commerce and labor docket for Monday, right, Senator Deeds? Monday's going to be a pretty busy day, I think. I just want to make sure everybody's aware of that. Things are starting to pile up here at the end of the session, so

[01:33:29] get ready to do some work next week. Is there any other business before the Senate? The clerk will report any announcements at the desk. Today, Friday, February 27th, the Committee for Courts of Justice will meet immediately upon adjournment at the chair's desk. Monday, March 2nd, 2026, The Committee for Courts of Justice will meet at 8 a.m. in Senate Room A, GAB.

[01:34:00] The Committee on Local Government will meet at 8 a.m. in Senate Room B, GAB. The Education and Health Subcommittee on Higher Education will meet at 8.30 a.m. in Senate Room C, GAB. The Democratic Caucus will meet at 11.15 a.m. in Senate Room 1, Capitol.

[01:34:19] The Republican Caucus will meet at 11.30 a.m. in Senate Room 2 of the Capitol. The weekend weather report. Today, highs in the low 50s, partly cloudy with patchy fog most of the evening. Temperatures dropping to the 30s Friday night.

[01:34:37] Saturday, patchy fog in the morning, then mostly sunny. Highs in the mid-60s. Areas of patchy fog develop overnight with temperatures dropping to the 40s. Sunday, early morning fog possible with a mix of sun and clouds.

[01:34:53] Temperatures reach low 60s and then fall quickly in the evening to the 30s. Wintry weather mix on Monday. The senator from Portsmouth.

[01:35:18] Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I move that the Senate do now adjourn until 12 noon on Monday. The question is, shall the Senate adjourn until 12 noon Monday? All in favor of the motion will say aye. Those opposed, no.

[01:35:33] The ayes have it. The motion is agreed to. The Senate stands adjourned until 12 noon Monday.

[01:35:38] Chamber. This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia. Senate Chamber. Be sure to stay connected with live sessions, catch up on past meetings, and explore our full archives anytime on the Senate of Virginia's YouTube channel.

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[02:00:36] Chamber.

[02:01:37] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia.

[02:04:17] Senate chamber.

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[02:13:17] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia

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[02:32:17] of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia, Senate Chamber. Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia, Chamber.

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[02:38:12] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia.

[02:38:41] Senate chamber.

[02:39:42] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia.

[02:41:46] Chamber.

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[02:56:43] Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia.

[02:57:44] Chamber.

[02:58:56] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia.

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[03:02:58] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia.

[03:04:06] Senate Chamber.

[03:05:53] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia.

[03:07:45] Senate Chamber.

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[03:09:44] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia.

[03:10:24] Chamber.

[03:11:25] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia.

[03:13:29] Senate Chamber. Be sure to stay connected with live sessions, catch up on past meetings,

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[03:16:11] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia.

[03:16:48] Chamber. The Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia.

[03:20:39] Chamber. Be sure to stay connected with live sessions, catch up on past meetings,

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[03:28:40] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia, Senate Chamber.

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[04:01:54] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia.

